I feel your gentleness more keenly than the blade of a sword

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I feel your gentleness more keenly than the blade of a sword

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Summary

He stepped closer, his head cocking to the side like an overgrown puppy. His blue eyed gaze dropped down to his waist for a moment before looking back up at him.

“...Are you hurt, Mydei?”

“...No. I was just startled.” Mydei muttered, looking away as he felt a surge of mortification. Thousands of deaths he had conquered and he flinched from a simple touch?

A surprised gasp escaped his lips when a palm cupped his waist. He looked up at Phainon, shivering when he saw how intently Phainon was studying him, his blue eyes stripping him bare.

Mydei finds out he's rather sensitive to gentle touches than he is to violence.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Mydei has experienced over a thousand deaths.

Rather ironic considering he was called Mydeimos the *Undying*. His first experience with life was dying as a child. And then it was a cycle of dying and drowning and living for nine winters because learning to swim whilst drowning as soon as you come back to life was arguably a little hard. This was all to say pain wasn't something that bothered him.

Medically speaking, drowning was supposed to be one of the most painful ways to die according to that journal Hyacine had given him. (“You don't value your life enough, Lord Mydei, so I can only hope to appeal to you by giving you this book.” She had told him once after treating his injuries despite him telling her not to bother.) Since he's drowned to death more than a thousand times it only made sense that he didn't flinch even in the face of decapitation.

Phainon was rather upset when it had happened, his hand making aborted moves towards his neck for the rest of that month. He didn’t understand the sentimentality but he let it slide. He looked like he was about to cry, after all.

So it truly took him by surprise when something as mundane as fingers brushing against his skin caused him to flinch and for his breath to hitch.

Like all things out of norm in his life—minus the usual stuff—it was because of Phainon.

His hand had brushed against the bare skin of his waist as he had walked past him, the touch accidental from how narrow the passage had become with the afternoon crowd in the Marmoreal market.

A foreign noise had escaped Mydei’s lips, choked and breathy. It was out even before he had a chance to bite his tongue, too surprised by the feel of the pads of Phainon’s sword roughened fingers against his bare skin. The place he had touched tingled, the touch making him shiver with a feeling he's never felt before.

This unfortunately did not escape Phainon's notice. The man despite his playful teasing was meticulous when it came to studying people. It was unnerving at first but Mydei had gotten used to it. He didn't really appreciate it at the moment, though.

He stepped closer, his head cocking to the side like an overgrown puppy. His blue eyed gaze dropped down to his waist for a moment before looking back up at him.

"...Are you hurt, Mydei?"

"...No. I was just startled." Mydei muttered, looking away as he felt a surge of mortification. Thousands of deaths he had conquered and he *flinched* from a simple touch?

A surprised gasp escaped his lips when a palm cupped his waist. He looked up at Phainon, shivering when he saw how intently Phainon was studying him, his blue eyes stripping him bare.

The combination of his calloused palm cradling Mydei's bare waist and those intense blue eyes studying him made him feel unusually hot, his head lightheaded. The skin under Phainon's palm tingled deliciously, making him bite his lip to stop any incriminating sound from coming out. He pressed his palms against Phainon's firm chest, his cheeks burning with embarrassment and his lungs feeling two sizes smaller.

"Just what. Do you think you are doing." He bit out with a snarl, the clawed tips of his gauntlet digging into Phainon's chest. No one has ever *dared* to touch him so brazenly, no one has ever thought to touch him outside of violence. The feeling was so foreign, the warmth and roughness of Phainon's palm against his skin made his head spin, his teeth digging harder into his lower lip as he felt something like a whine make its way up his throat when Phainon's fingers gently pressed into his flesh. Phainon studied his face, a small smile pulling at his lips. His warm blue eyes curved into mischievous crescents.

"Are you, perhaps…ticklish?"

Mydei growled, finally pushing the man away with a huff. He crossed his arms defensively, choosing to glare at Phainon's well endowed chest instead of his face. The belt that ran across

his chest to fasten his pauldron and cape always looked like it worked overtime keeping his chest from spilling out of his shirt.

“Do you usually go around groping people and asking if they were ticklish? Is that a pastime of yours, Deliverer?” He bit out, the place where Phainon’s hand had been still scalding hot.

“G-groping…?” Phainon stammered with wide eyes, his cheeks pink.

“I simply placed my hand on your waist!”

He squawked indignantly, unfortunately attracting the attention of the street vendors and citizens.

“Besides you didn't answer my question!” Phainon said with a pout, opening his stupid mouth again to probably mention how Mydei was brought to his knees from just a simple touch when everyone was watching them and Mydei—

Mydei simply turned around and walked away. He did not *run*, no. He walked briskly with wide steps. He was not *running away*, he was *strategically retreating*.

When he made it back to his sleeping quarters and put his teleslate on silent mode he hoped Phainon would drop this subject and never bring it up again.

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He knew it was wishful thinking to ever hope that Phainon would ever forget anything. The Deliverer of the Flame Chase was unfortunately a tenacious man.

He had remembered Mydei’s preference for sweets, noticed he liked chimeras, knew the measurements of his body, his calculation of the circumference of his waist and his bust size more accurate than what he even remembered. So it was to no one’s surprise that Mydei was put to the test as soon as he was woken up.

“You know…you could have been a little softer with the punch.” Phainon grumbled as he leaned back in the bath, looking very unbothered by his purpling cheek despite his complaints.

“And you could have woken me up like you always do by shaking my shoulders instead of blowing a raspberry into my belly.” Mydei growled, crossing his arms. His ears were still burning from the encounter, the spot where Phainon’s lips and tongue touched was still tingling with a weird warmth. Phainon whined, his lips comically turned upside down as he waded to where Mydei was lounging, a little farther than he usually did after Phainon’s stunt.

“I just want to know if you’re ticklish!” Phainon asked, his hand coming up to play with Mydei’s braid like he couldn’t stand still without messing with him. Mydei made an irritated noise in his throat, ignoring the weird feeling in his chest as Phainon gently played with his braid.

“...And what will you do with information like that?” He asked, resigned and weary. It was already alarming to him that he couldn’t even handle touches that were considered casual between friends, too used to rough clasps on his shoulders and slaps on his back and much too familiar with blades lodged into his chest and fists against his skin. Gentle touches like absently touching his waist with sword worn fingers or blowing raspberries into his skin was so alien. Phainon cocked his head, looking too much like a clueless chimera, raising the hand holding the braid to brush the back of his knuckles against Mydei’s cheek.

“I want to learn everything about you, even the endearing sides…especially the endearing ones.” He said with a smile that displayed his dimples, his face stupidly handsome and his demeanour too stupidly charming. He sighed, already feeling himself giving in, mortification burning his skin as he looked away, his arms tightening in their crossed position against his chest.

“I…” He began, the shame making him a little nauseous as he squeezed his eyes shut.

“I’m not used to touches that aren’t ones that happen on a battlefield.” He said, his voice soft. The silence that followed was uncomfortable so much so that he wanted to leave and maybe go outside and kill black tide creatures and titankin instead, maybe go on a week-long expedition and return and hope Phainon would just forget everything. When he turned around

to go and do just that, a firm hand wrapped around his wrist. His breath hitched, his cheeks heating as he gently attempted to tug his hand from Phainon's grip.

"...Let go." He said, quiet and ashamed.

He gasped when he was pulled into a warm body instead, his breath stuttering in his chest when he felt sturdy arms wrap around his waist and pull him into a gentle embrace, his back bumping into Phainon's bare chest. He felt soft hair against his cheek and a nose against his neck.

"...What are you doing?" He asked, unable to control the tremor in his voice. Everything was so warm and smelt like Phainon, like bulrushes and sunwarmed clothes and it was all a little too much. He wanted more. His hands remained frozen by his sides, his eyes wide as he stared sightlessly in front of him.

"I'm sorry for teasing you in the market…I didn't know."

Phainon said, genuinely sounding contrite. Mydei felt a hysterical chuckle escape him, the absurdity of the situation a bit much for him.

"Why are you sorry about this? There was no way you could have known, Deliverer."

Mydei gasped when Phainon wrapped his arms tighter around him, his eyelashes now tickling the skin of his neck from the proximity.

"I…want to introduce you to…non violent touches if that is okay." Phainon murmured into his skin, making Mydei's skin burn, his head dizzy with overstimulation, his chest sweetly aching with a foreign emotion.

"...You are a fool." He managed to say, hoping his voice sounded calm and even. At this point, Phainon had him fully in his embrace, his generous chest pressed against his sensitive back, his lower half a respectful distance away. It was nice, too nice. The warmth engulfed

him, melting his brain and making him hyper-aware of the gentle strength of Phainon's embrace, his warm scent, his soft hair, his really…*really* nice voice—

"If…that is the case…can you start smaller?" Mydei said, his voice embarrassingly cracking, knowing full well that he was probably red from head to toe now. He hopes Phainon thinks it's the bath or at least doesn't acknowledge it. His pride can't take anymore beatings today. He heard Phainon make a noise of surprise, his arms loosening their embrace and his warmth retreating. Mydei still felt the ghost of it against his skin, he wished to feel that warmth again and it scared him.

He turns back to see a sheepish Phainon, relieved to see his cheeks were pink with embarrassment too.

"H-how about I wash your hair?" Phainon asked, fidgeting nervously when Mydei didn't immediately answer.

"I-I won't touch anything else I swear." He said in a rush, his blue eyes watery and earnest, again, a little too reminiscent of a chimera. Mydei sighed, still unsure of the arrangement but unable to entirely deny Phainon when he was being this earnest.

"Be quick. I will allow it only if it is for about one-eighth a quint" he said, turning away and closing his eyes, his shoulders stiffening when he felt Phainon wade close to him again. He was led by his shoulders to be close to the lip of the bath beside the toiletry, swallowing when he felt light touches on his hair, too faint to be properly felt.

"I've always thought your hair was rather voluminous and soft for someone who regularly drenches himself in ichor." Phainon murmured almost absently before he felt fingers card through his hair and brush his scalp, the tension in his shoulders melting before he even registered that it did, sagging a little against the man behind him with a sigh.

"Good?" he heard Phainon ask, the smile in his voice blatantly obvious.

"You haven't even started washing my hair, Deliverer. Don't be so smug." Mydei grumbled.

Phainon huffed a helpless laugh, the click of a bottle and the squeeze of product heard before he started lathering the shampoo into Mydei's hair. A soft noise escaped his throat when Phainon massaged his scalp, his eyelids fluttering and threatening to close from how good it felt. His fingers were thorough and firm in a way that was so unfamiliar, too used to people taking advantage of his long mane to yank it in battle. He bit his lips when he realized he just wouldn't *stop* making soft helpless noises, the gentle pressure on his scalp addicting.

He didn't realize he had slumped even more against Phainon to the point that his back was against his chest again, his shoulder blade tingling from the reverberation of Phainon's soft laugh.

"I can't wash your hair like this! You're like an overgrown chimera." Phainon said with a louder laugh, his chest shaking with it and it all felt so…so good. Too good for someone like him, someone so used to violence.

"Between the two of us, you resemble a chimera more with your huge, protruding eyes." He grumbled and stood straighter, smiling when he heard Phainon squawk.

"Pro…Protuding?!" He said indignantly, grabbing the bucket beside him and upturning a deluge of warm bathwater over Mydei's head with no warning. Mydei growled, turning around, grabbing Phainon by the shoulders and pushing him into the water.

"Wait! Wait, I need to—*blurblelble*—put conditioner in your hair!"

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Phainon was surprisingly gentlemanly about learning about Mydei's weakness. But that also meant he was a little awkward.

"You…ah…um. Can I braid your hair?" Phainon asked a few days after the incident at the bath. Despite learning about Mydei's sensitivity to touch he didn't push him during any of the baths that followed the hair washing. His hands twitched and he looked like he wanted to ask Mydei every single time but he stopped himself at the last minute, opting to simply talk

Mydei's ear off like he usually did. He didn't mind that either. Contrary to what most people believed, he truly enjoyed Phainon's company.

It was nice to have the companionship of a man with strength that rivaled his, with a personality as sweet as his and charm so magnetic he pulled Mydei into his orbit without realizing it. When he was with Phainon he could simply be Mydei and not Mydeimos of Castrum Kremnos.

It was also because of this that he lamented seeing him struggle so much, especially when the said struggle was because of him.

"Deliverer," He said, looking up at the fidgeting man. They were seated in the Garden of Life with chimeras in their laps and Phainon had been eyeing his unravelled braid since they had entered. It had been at least two quints.

"You needn't be so hesitant with me, I am not made of porcelain." He said with a sigh, moving closer while being careful with the two chimeras sleeping in his lap and tilting his head, offering his unravelled braid to Phainon.

He felt trembling hands against his braid as if Mydei had offered him something precious.

"I didn't want to overstep or make you uncomfortable…You seemed genuinely distressed after admitting what you admitted in the baths and I felt like I forced you to say it."

He said quietly, his voice thick. His head was ducked down so Mydei couldn't see his expression but he could see the slump of his shoulders.

"You…did put me on the spot." He sighed when Phainon let go of his braid and meekly curled his hands back into his lap.

"...But that doesn't mean I don't appreciate anything you did." He grumbled, feeling his face flush in embarrassment, unused to laying such tender feelings out in the open.

“...I enjoyed you washing my hair. I would like it if you did it again and if I could in turn return the favour and wash your hair.” He mumbled, looking away when Phainon’s head snapped up in surprise, his blue eyes sparkling and his cheeks pink and it was a little too much for Mydei. He shuffled closer with those glittering eyes and gently took hold of Mydei’s braid again, his large hands a little clumsy as they braided his hair.

The braid ended up being a little skewed and loose but Mydei kept it till the next day when it eventually unravelled.

After that, Phainon was a little bit more straightforward. Still a little unsure but pushing forward as was norm for him considering his bullheaded nature.

He held Mydei’s hand when they walked through the crowded agora, took to braiding Mydei’s hair as often as he could, his braids now more sturdy and neat. He even sat closer, his broad shoulder brushing Mydei’s bare one now when they squabbled or tangling his feet with Mydei’s under the table when they went out to eat. He even washed Mydei’s hair regularly, trying out different scented oils and shampoos every time. It felt almost indulgent, the days feeling too much like the melting of honeycakes in his mouth.

But alas, as most things do during an era of tragedy and strife, idyllic days of peace are only a temporary fleeting thing. They were called to cull a mass of black tide monsters that had cropped up in the dead city of Carmitis, Aglaea’s face severe in a way Mydei hadn’t seen in a long time.

“There is no one else we can spare. It will be only the two of you,” She said, looking pained by that despite her claims of being unfeeling and cold. Mydei simply put his gauntleted fist to his chest and grinned.

“The Deliverer and I have been cooped inside for far too long. You needn’t worry about rabble.”

Phainon seemed a little worried but that was not anything new. He simply bumped his shoulder against his and cocked his head towards the exit of the baths, jumping down from the heroes' baths to make his way to where Kokopo III was stationed.

“...She looked alarmed in a way I’ve never seen before.” Phainon said with furrowed brows, a little later into the journey. The both decided to take one Dromas, opting to not use the Century gate because of the possibility of another swarm of black tide creatures popping up when they were away. Their shoulders brushed and Mydei bit back the urge to move closer and press his entire arm against Phainon’s warm and firm one.

“It’s hard not to be. It’s been a while since we’ve seen this many in one of the fallen city-states.” He said with a sigh. While his words to Aglaea were confident it didn’t mean he wasn’t wary. He used to be a war general, he was not a fool.

“But we will simply clear the skirmish like we usually do. Stop fretting.”

He said with a grunt, smiling when he heard Phainon make an indignant noise, the tension in his shoulders having dissipated a little.

The clean up wasn’t going too bad.

The battlefield was the ruins of the city’s marketplace, a place that was once vibrant with life and known for its man-made lake—a water body used by many couples to cruise on canoes and to propose to loved ones. It was now stagnant and murky, even the eggs of waterborne insects and mucky algae that would usually inhabit abandoned water bodies gone without a trace.

The two of them worked really well on the battlefield. They could read each other’s moves and move on instinct, compensating for the other’s weak spots seamlessly. It was almost like a waltz, the intimacy of it always making Mydei giddy with a feeling he couldn’t name.

Maybe it was because he’d grown soft from all the pampering that he made a stupid mistake.

He’d been keeping an eye on Phainon in the periphery of his vision when he saw him fall, his heart seizing in his chest and his eyes widening in panic, missing a creature that came up to him in his brief moment of worry and cleaved his shoulder, causing him to stumble and lose footing, belatedly realizing just how close he was to the lake. The last thing he heard before falling into the depths of Carmitis’ once romantic water cruising destination was a muffled call of his name and then it was the rush of water and the muted pop of his eardrums as he began to sink into the depths.

His eyes widened, blind in the murky darkness of the water, his hands clawing upwards to the surface. It was like he was back in the sea of souls. The first thing his conscience had registered after being born was the agonizing burn of his lungs, too weak to cry out in pain as he died mere moments after being thrown into the waters. It was the only things he remembered for years, opening his eyes to the blinding black waters, the burn of his lungs, his soundless screams.

And here he was again.

He thought that would have been the last of it, trading his years of desolate loneliness and helplessness for the kinder pain of dying in the battlefield to blades. He desperately clawed his way to the surface, fighting his panic with the rationality of a seasoned war veteran. He could swim, he *knew* how to swim, he lived in the sea for years, this was nothing.

And yet his body was heavy, weighing him down, even as he tried to swim to the surface, his heart plummeting to his stomach when he realized that the creature who had attacked him was wrapped around him and struggling mindlessly, pulling the both of them under. Anxiety welled up in his throat, nauseating and cold, his breath hitching when he began to swallow mouthfuls of water after his lungs had given up on holding his breath, the familiar agonizing burn in his lungs unwelcome. He won't make it back up to the surface.

He kicked the creature pulling him down, ignoring the burning of his lungs and his hazy consciousness to dig his claws into corrupted flesh and rip and tear and rip more, his inevitable death making him more feral in his endeavor to at least kill one of these abominations before he died and began his futile attempts to reach the surface, his lips pulling back in a snarl as he felt death pull him closer in an embrace, ignoring the useless terror he felt in the pit of his stomach, tearing at flesh till he died.

His throat was thick with anxiety but he never forgot what he needed to do, what he needed to keep his people safe, to keep Phainon safe. So despite the cold clutches of fear he waded against the currents of death and clawed his way back to life.

He knew he'd be greeted by frigid water but it was nice to imagine being wrapped in Phainon's arms again like he did only once back in the baths. The embrace had been warm

and the assuring weight against his back had been so good, the feeling of security so foreign that he didn't realize that's what it was until a few days later.

He missed that now, wished he got to embrace Phainon more, greedy for that scalding encompassing warmth.

He felt himself take a deep breath that rattled his lungs when his soul was forcefully pulled back into his body, immediately turning over to hack and cough up the stale water in his lungs, instinct raising his hackles when he felt something wrap around him right after and restricting the movement of his arms, the surprise of waking up trapped making him sink his teeth into whatever he could reach, his legs kicking out in alarm when the thing didn't budge.

He didn't understand, he was supposed to be in the bottom of the lake, did something pull him out and trap him? If yes, what happened to Phainon? By the titans…what happened to Phainon? He was so distracted because of a nonsensical mistake and his cowardliness and now Phainon—

"Mydei! *Ghh*—can you stop biting my shoulder?" He heard a familiar voice say, his senses slowly returning to realize the restriction around his body was just a gentle embrace, reminiscent of the one he and Phainon had shared in the heroes' baths but this time he was on his back and Phainon was hunched over him. He released the pressure of his tightening jaws on Phainon's shoulder and slumped back down, the fight or flight instinct in him fizzling away into nothing and being replaced by a bone-tired fatigue.

Phainon looked surprisingly fine with only smears of dirt on his cheek and clothes, the small cuts on his skin comparatively negligible to the nasty bite on his shoulder that was sluggishly bleeding and the deep scratch marks on his arms. It didn't take him long to realize that those marks matched his gauntlets.

"You don't need to worry about those," He heard Phainon say gently, his eyes wildly snapping back to look up at him again.

His expression was soft, worried and pained, his hunched shoulders and his strong arms curled over and around him like he was protecting him, a bulwark in a raging sea. He didn't try to struggle away from the embrace, his stomach twisting in guilt and something else, hating how Phainon's expression simply turned softer after studying his face, unwrapping

one of his arms from the embrace to cup Mydei's cheek. It was all so achingly gentle and undeserving and his throat closed up, his eyes burning.

"...The enemies," He managed to say around the lump in his throat, ignoring the tremble in his fingers as he snagged the cloth of Phainon's overcoat.

"We made quick work of them, don't worry your pretty little head." He murmured with a teasing smile, the pads of his fingers brushing beneath one of Mydei's eyes. His breath stuttered, a noise escaping him before he could stop it, his heart aching something fierce. This was all a little too much, the softness and warmth worse than a blade to his chest.

"I hurt you," He said, his voice thick and rough, his throat feeling tender. Phainon simply huffed, curving his hand over the small of his back to scoop him up to a sitting position and making him lean against his chest, uncaring of the open wound on his shoulder.

"I startled you, you were in distress. I could have been a little more gentle whilst handling you but I didn't want you to remain in the water," He said, cradling the back of his neck and making him put his whole weight against him. He wrapped him up in an embrace again, trapping Mydei's hands against his chest.

"You have my thanks for saving me, I will make sure I return the favour in kind." Mydei said softly, blindsided and lost.

"But I don't understand why you—"

He began before pausing, unsure of how to express his confusion and ache.

"...When I used to have nightmares as a child, I used to rest better in the arms of my mother." Phainon murmured against his hair, his hand absently stroking up and down Mydei's spine, unaware of how close he was to Mydei's weakness.

"After my village—After I left Aedes Elysiae, when nightmares plagued me I would remember the warmth of my mother's embrace and despite it being something I will never feel again I used to take solace in what I could remember." The pads of his fingers were

rough but so…so gentle on Mydei's bare skin. He shivered, unconsciously curling closer, embarrassment burning his ears. His hands balled into fists against Phainon's bosom.

"I…was late to notice your fall, your absence, something I could only register when all the black tide monsters had fallen." Phainon's voice shook, his embrace tightening for a moment.

"When I realized what had happened, I dived down to save you and by the time I had taken you back out, you were cold." He buried his face in Mydei's neck, pulling him so close he was almost in his lap.

"You were pale and your eyes were wide and unseeing with terror and anguish, clawed marks around your throat."

"Phainon," He began, the ache in his heart almost as agonizing as the burn was in his lungs.

"When you woke up next you were making these…" He heard Phainon inhale sharply, his fingers trembling.

"These agonized noises in your throat and I couldn't do anything until you regained lucidity and I thought that holding you close would—"

He heard him audibly swallow and take deep breaths as if he was trying to keep it together, the now noticeable shake in his hands against Mydei's back giving him away. He gently separated him and shuffled backwards, his expression shadowed by the fall of his snow white hair as he ducked his head down, his hands clenched into fists and placed on his knees as if he was in repentance.

"I'm sorry…It was selfish. I wanted to be that comforting warmth for you after failing to have your back but I realize how overwhelming it would have been for—"

His breath hitched when Mydei simply closed the gap between them by crawling over and placing himself in Phainon's lap.

"You are a fool." He said simply, cupping Phainon's cheeks to tilt his head and make their gazes meet again. Phainon looked surprised, his eyes red like he was going to cry. He sighed, making an awkward aborted movement to embrace the man he was sitting on before exhaling sharply and properly wrapping his arms around him. His anxious thoughts from before and the terror it came along with dissipated in the warmth of their embrace, a soft noise escaping him when Phainon returned the embrace after a moment.

"...It was nice. This—this is nice." He murmured, hoping it was enough for Phainon to understand, too exhausted and hollowed out to say anything else, hoping he was able to convey his sincerity with just those words and his embrace.

He closed his eyes, a smile tugging at his lips with Phainon simply pulled him closer, the warmth making him feel like they were in their own world and not among the viscera of monsters in a city long fallen.

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Something changed after that. Something that either of them refused to name.

The touches turned more casual and all encompassing, Phainon plopping beside Mydei on his bed and cuddling him after their late night baths, citing a clumsy reason of not being able to make it back to his quarters because he was tired. Mydei didn't mind, indulging in the feel of firm muscles wrapping around him and warm breath against his nape. It was embarrassing to admit how secure he felt, the feeling so foreign to someone like him.

Mydei took to absently playing with the collar around Phainon's neck and brushing his fingers over Phainon's cheeks, secretly delighted by how pink they would turn when he did that without his gauntlets. So when Phainon embraced him from behind in the baths one day without a word, Mydei simply sank into the embrace, leaning his head into the crook of Phainon's neck, his back brushing against the bare skin of Phainon's chest.

It felt good, dizzyingly so. Phainon placed his hands in the divots of Mydei's hips, hesitant at first before settling firmly there when he didn't hear any complaining.

"Okay?" He murmured into Mydei's neck. Mydei simply hummed, biting his lower lip when the hands on his hips began to gently knead. Was this how casual touches between comrades usually were? He'd been deprived of non-violent touch for so long that something like this was making the blood rush to his cheeks and down south, his head light as if any thought that had been there before had promptly melted. He felt pampered and spoiled by how good this felt, distantly concerned by how addicting the feel of Phainon's sword calluses felt against his skin.

"Do..," Mydei began before sighing softly in pleasure when he was pulled closer.

"Do comrades usually partake in actions such as this?" He asked, his voice breathy, his skin flushing when he felt his cock twitch. Phainon had his waist conspicuously away from Mydei's lower half, considerate enough to not press his bare dick against Mydei's ass. They usually bathed in the nude without even a towel for modesty. What need was there for modesty when they were comrades familiar with each other's body from all their bouts of combat?

They had just started forgoing towels after the amount of times Phainon dragged Mydei to the baths, the usage of towels becoming nonsensically wasteful.

They've seen each other's dicks, it was hard not to when they were in close proximity. Phainon had simply flushed and looked away the first time he'd seen his dick, his eyes always remaining above waist level from then on but he had seen Phainon's gaze linger a little too long when he thought Mydei wasn't looking.

He wonders if it's because his dick wasn't as impressive as Phainon's, the man's cock heavy and gargantuan looking even when it was flaccid. Was Mydei's dick a mockery in comparison? Not that he particularly cared but the first time he had seen Phainon's dick and compared it to his, his stomach had felt weird and he was unbearably hot like he had somehow fallen sick. If they were to compare the sizes, the several inch difference was glaringly obvious and something about that made his navel mysteriously tingle. He wonders if it's because *he* was upset about some comparison contest the both of them had that he wasn't privy to.

He was brought back to the present when Phainon dragged a hand up to his ribs, the thin skin over there sensitive and ticklish, making Mydei squirm, a bitten off high pitched noise escaping him before he could stop it. Phainon paused, his hand curved right below his chest.

“So you *are* ticklish!” Phainon said, brushing his hand down Mydei’s ribs.

“You've become far too brazen, Deliverer.”

He grabbed that unruly hand and turned around with a glare. Phainon simply smiled at him, his eyes wide with feigned innocence. He gently extricated his hand from Mydei’s grip to curve them around his waist again, almost as if he was loath to part with it. Mydei flushed, bracing himself against Phainon’s chest.

He wasn't sure he could call the touches and intimacy casual with how much it affected him, a mere brush against his skin making him feel a little too much but also wanting it to never stop. It was like Phainon had fashioned him into a different person, an instrument of war turned into one of hedonism.

He pressed his deliciously rough fingers into his sensitive flesh and simply began to stroke from his upper thighs to the sides of his chest, prompting an embarrassingly needy noise to spill from his lips as he curled his fingers into the plushness of Phainon’s chest.

“If you don’t like it I can stop,” Phainon said, his eyes dark and his cheeks flushed. Mydei leaned closer as if in a trance, one of his hands dragging up Phainon’s chest, brushing the sunburst on his neck before cupping his flushed cheek.

“For you to look so flustered…is that what one would consider normal?” He murmured, pressing closer, gasping when Phainon scooped him up and placed him on his strong thighs. He groaned, gripping Mydei closer to him, his cheeks and ears turning an even brighter red than they initially were.

“Have you seen yourself? How am I supposed to act normal?”

He whined, his fingers digging into the flesh of Mydei's waist as he looked up at Mydei with wet eyes pleading for *something*. Mydei bit his lip, dizzy from the heady proximity, his stomach tingly and warm from how firm Phainon's thighs were, his dick giving a traitorous twitch. He pushed himself closer, his body moving on its own at this point, ensnared by Phainon's gaze.

"Speak plainly, Deliverer," He breathed, the bulk of his chest squishing against Phainon's bosom. He shivered when the man's erect nipple brushed against his areola, his nipple still tucked inside, the slit from where it would bloom sensitive from the proximity. His dazed gaze slipped down when he felt something nudge his inner thigh, his eyes widening and his breath hitching when he saw what it was.

He knew Phainon was huge but it was more pronounced next to his. His dick had always been smaller than average, nothing he truly cared about in the grand scheme of things but seeing it beside Phainon's which was wider and longer, its thick girth making his look rather slender in comparison. He'd barely be able to wrap his hand around its circumference while his dick was usually dwarfed by the largeness of his hand when he occasionally touched himself. Phainon's dick twitched under his gaze and by the Titans, his throat was so dry.

He swallowed, studying the prominent vein that ran down its shaft, its wide head and the way it curved. He wonders how it would feel if it pushed its blunt tip into him, bullied its thick girth inside him and forced him wide open. He knows the way it curved it would easily find that place he's only ever read about, messing him up inside and ruining him. He barely registered the hungry noise that escaped his panting mouth, standing up abruptly when it *did* register a few moments later, the coldness of fear and the burn of mortification at odds with each other as he turned to leave.

"I'm sorry," He said in a rush, not waiting to hear Phainon's response as he rushed back to the changing room to hastily put his chiton on his damp skin, uncaring of his clothes getting soaked as he left Phainon behind like a cowardly *hks*.

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He wasn't avoiding Phainon per se.

It was a mistake.

After he had come back from the baths, he managed to stumble to bed and grab the massage oil he kept on his bedside, pouring oil over his fingers with shaking hands before he unceremoniously shoved two fingers inside him. He gasped through the dryness and the foreign feeling of something stretching his hole.

He never tried before, never considered laying in bed beside someone if it wasn't just sleeping. Sex was just something that he never thought too much about, quick masturbation sessions only being something he did out of frustration. This was, in that sense, not that much different. It usually was impatient and full of pent up energy but this was worse.

He shoved another finger in him, spreading his thighs to maneuver them inside him better. A noise of frustration escaped him when it just didn't satisfy the particular craving he wanted, The hazy thoughts of Phainon's dark eyes and flushed cheeks and his thick cock tipping him over into delirium as he shoved four fingers inside him, the pressure delicious but still not enough. He wanted to feel the way his fat cockhead snagged on his rim, feel the way it bullied its way into him, making his hole learn the shape of his cock.

Mydei's vision turned hazy as he imagined those four fingers to be Phainon's calloused ones, shoving them inside him to stretch him loose so he could take his cock whenever he wanted, make him sit on it all day and fuck his brains out till all he could think of was Phainon stuffing him full. He barely recognized the choked hungry noises escaping his throat as he crooked his fingers and jabbed again and again till his fleshy insides yielded and he found his sweet spot, his eyes rolling back into his skull as he spilled onto the sheets, his cock untouched.

His post orgasm haze dissipated into cold awareness when he heard the buzz of his teleslate, his clumsy hands reaching over to see that Phainon had called and he'd completely missed it. His stomach turned when he saw a message notification with his name flash. He flipped it over, refusing to read the message as he curled up in bed, his head in too much a mess. He will get up later to clean up and pretend everything is fine when Phainon comes to wake him up for breakfast and their morning bath but for now he's going to lie face-down and question all the decisions he's made that led him here.

When he wakes up from his uneasy slumber he's unsettled by how out of place it feels, his head still groggy as he checks the time on his teleslate only to jolt up in bed when he realizes its a whole four quints past the time he's usually woken up by Phainon, an uneasy feeling settling in his stomach. He opened the text he'd left unread last night before groaning.

[Yesterday]

Deliverer:

Hey Mydei, can we talk? I feel like I crossed a line today and made you uncomfortable. That is why you left, right?

[Today]

Deliverer:

I'm sorry, I won't bother you today. I hope you'll give me a chance to apologize.

He cursed under his breath, feeling too much like an immature child. One thing he learnt during his campaign when he was a war general was that even the smallest miscommunication could lead to dire circumstances. And he knows this time he was to blame. So as much as he hated it, as much as he dreaded it, he made the first move to clear the misunderstanding. He called Phainon's number, half expecting it to be ignored after how he'd missed his call and ignored his text. It would have been a fair reaction, Mydei wouldn't have blamed him. But Phainon wasn't that type of man. He was rather tender hearted and insecure but he was also bullheaded and stubborn and would never leave anything half done. He had the markings of a storybook hero; not that he would ever accept that. He was frustratingly humble.

"...Hello…? Mydei?"

Mydei bit his lip, feeling a little nauseous from the bout of anxiety that gripped him. But this was Phainon, his rival, his partner…his equal. He didn't want to squander what they had.

"We need to talk." He said, cringing when he heard how rough his voice was. He'd forgotten to clear his throat, his voice still gravelly with the morning grit.

"Are…are you okay? You sound—Did I make you cry?"

“Hks.” He growled, cutting off Phainon’s panicking voice that was pitching higher with every made up issue he was cooking up in his head.

“I just woke up, thanks to my usual alarm clock not waking me up and making me miss the golden honeycakes they make fresh in the *beginning* of Lucid hour.” He grumbled, making an aborted move to cross his arms before realizing he had his teleslate to his ear.

There was a pause before Phainon spoke, sounding too much like how he’d imagine a kicked chimera would sound.

“I…I’m sorry,” he said, making Mydei feel terrible. He exhaled harshly, pinching the bridge of his nose.

“Just…just come here,” He said, cutting the call before Phainon found a new way to self-flagellate.

Phainon knocked on his door instead of barging like he usually did. Mydei swallowed his guilt and opened the door and Phainon…Phainon looked tired like he hadn’t slept since the last time Mydei had seen him. His usually vibrant blue eyes were dull with fatigue and weariness, the usual jovial curve of his mouth now stretched thin with tension.

“Mydei I–” Mydei grabbed his wrist and pulled him inside, the hand dragging up to cradle the sunburst on Phainon’s neck. He couldn’t meet Phainon’s eyes, not yet, so he looked at his chin instead. It was a charming chin.

“Before you apologize, *again*. I’d like to clear up that you do not bear any fault for my actions.”

He said softly, biting his lip when he heard Phainon’s breath hitch. The next words were hard to say but it was his responsibility. If he could not even keep his relationship with Phainon intact, how was he supposed to help his people?

“I left because,” He cleared his throat when his voice cracked, his other hand coming up to clutch the belt that ran across Phainon’s chest—a means to ground himself.

“I left because you—” He cursed. Why was this so hard?

“I left because there’s no one who has made me feel…the way you make me feel. You’re touch is so gentle and yet it feels like you’ve peeled me apart and sunk your teeth into my insides and I…” He exhaled shakily.

“I like it a little too much. And I want…more. I want you to touch me more and it—” He sighs, stepping back and shaking his head. He had a whole speech planned, he even thought of cooking the both of them breakfast but it was getting out of hand and he was afraid. *Scared* that Phainon would push him away, look at him with disgust. Or worse, smile at him and tell him he was simply just unused to touch and latched on to him like a needy parasite.

“Deliverer. I apologize for making you come all this way and—” He gasped when he was pulled closer by a hand on the small of his back, his eyes widening in surprise when he finally looked up at Phainon’s face.

His cheeks were flushed a charming rouge, his eyes sharp with determination, that arresting gaze fixed on him as he was pulled closer.

“Is that all?” He said softly.

“What?” Mydei managed to say, his lungs feeling like they were two sizes smaller. He bit his lip, swallowing when Phainon followed the action intently with his eyes. His hand slid around to grab his waist, pulling him even closer. A soft noise escaped his lips, his eyelids fluttering from the delicious way Phainon’s fingers dug into the meat of his waist.

“You accuse me of self flagellation on a daily basis when you seem to be practicing the very thing you admonish me for.” Phainon murmured with a frown, pushing him up against the wall beside the door which was still ajar.

“I do not self flagellate, I'm simply a realist, something an idealist like you wouldn't understand.” Mydei retorted with a glare which was probably rendered rather ineffective from how flustered he was from the position he was in, trapped between the wall and the press of Phainon’s body against his.

“And you don’t think it's…*realistic* that I'd want to touch you as much as you want to be touched?” Phainon asked incredulously as he dragged his hand up to grab his chest, his cheeks heating up when his sword roughened hand squeezed it shamelessly, his head dizzy as he stared at the way his flesh spilled in between Phainon’s fingers.

A whine spilled from his lips, his toes curling when Phainon simply used both his hands to knead his chest, mortification and arousal burning his skin as he gasped out needy noises.

“I've…I've wanted to do this for a while. Your chest is so gorgeous, your nipples so shy and cute and I—” Phainon broke off with a groan of his own as he rubbed his areolas with his thumbs, his cock filling up in his flimsy chiton when Phainon slips the tips of his thumbs into his areolas, a soft and wanton sound escaping his lips, his knees too weak to hold his weight as he stumbled to the ground only to be stopped by a thick thigh between his legs.

“Pha—” he began, only to whine again as he squirmed on that firm thigh that pressed right under his balls, his chiton obscenely rucked up by his twitching cock. Between the hands lewdly kneading his chest and the thigh rocking into him, he was lost to pleasure, his vision blurry with tears as he clawed Phainon’s arms helplessly, pitchy needy noises spilling from wet parted lips.

He was unconscious to the fact that he had begun to ride Phainon’s thigh on his own accord to seek pleasure and pressing his chest into Phainon’s probing hands, his eyelashes clumped from unshed tears.

“Good?” Phainon murmured into his ear, his breath hot and his hands unrelenting. Mydei could only manage to whine, crying out when Phainon ducked his head down to place his mouth over his chest to coax his nipple out, his tongue wiggling into the slit in his areola as he sucked with a demanding pressure as if he wanted to draw milk from his chest. Needy keens spilled from his mouth, his tongue lolling out as he pressed his head against the wall, thrashing under Phainon’s firm hold. His shy nipple popped out from his slit, reddened and sensitive and slick with Phainon’s spit. He simply moved to coax the other nipple out while pinching and pulling and bullying the one out of its sheath, the sheer pleasure-pain from him

stimulating Mydei's nipples and his muscled thigh rubbing the underside of his balls and taint brought him to completion, his eyes rolling back as he spilled all over himself, his bare thighs quivering.

"Hks." He managed, his voice ruined as he buried his face in Phainon's neck, his chest heaving from the orgasm. Phainon groaned, his hands balled into fists on either side of Mydei, his arms trembling.

"That…that was really hot." He rasped, prompting Mydei to claw red lines into his arms.

"...Shameless." Mydei hissed, managing to flush in embarrassment despite everything that had transpired. He squirmed in his wispy chiton now ruined with cum and sweat, his fingers scratching more lines down Phainon's arms, wishing he'd worn his gauntlets to bed.

"You've made me all sweaty and disgusting because you couldn't wait. Shut the door and take me to my private bath." He growled imperiously, pulling Phainon's hair when he didn't move, gasping when he was hoisted up into Phainon's arms like a hapless maiden.

The ease with which Phainon switched to holding Mydei with just an arm when he shut the door and the way he playfully bounced him in his arms as he walked to Mydei's room should not be as arousing as it was but by the Titans did it make him dizzy with want, his hands looped helplessly around Phainon's broad shoulders as he was carried effortlessly all the way to his bath.

He was still weak kneed by Phainon's display of strength by the time he put him down and would have fallen to his knees if Phainon hadn't held him up with an arm around his waist.

"Is this because you made us miss our daily morning bath and breakfast together?" Phainon asked with a teasing smile, curling his braid playfully around a finger. Mydei scoffed, pushing him away and pulling his chiton off with a swipe of his arm, smirking when he saw Phainon eyeing his movements with a hungry look in his eyes.

"You mean, *you* made us miss our morning bath and breakfast." He said, crossing his arms. Phainon shrugged helplessly, slinking closer to put his arms around Mydei's waist again like

it was his favorite place.

“Forgive me?” He said, tilting his head and acting all cute. He hated that it was working.

“Shameless.” Mydei said, pinching his cheek with something that felt too much like fondness bubbling up his chest.

“Besides,” he murmured, cupping Phainon’s face to make sure they maintained steady eye contact.

“Didn't you just have your breakfast?” his eyes fell to half mast as he dragged his hand down to Phainon’s choker to pull him closer. Phainon groaned, his fingers digging into Mydei's waist, their faces so close that their lips brushed every time they breathed.

“That was merely a taste…surely you'll let me have more, yeah?” He said against Mydei’s lips, leaning even closer to capture his mouth before he could answer.

The kiss started slowly, just a press of lips and teasing nips. But then Phainon licked the seam of his lips and when he gasped from the flash of heat, he took his opportunity to plunder Mydei’s mouth, Phainon’s tongue greedy as it licked inside and curled around his, wet and sloppy and scaldingly hot. He whined into his mouth, blindly pulling at one of the various belts on Phainon’s frustratingly complex overcoat for him to strip and for him to feel his warm skin and firm muscles.

He bit Phainon’s lower lip, swallowing the needy moan it elicited before parting, his chest heaving as he gulped in breaths of air.

“Mm. You can eat as much as you want,” he said, his voice soft as he brushed Phainon’s reddened lower lip with his thumb.

“But first.” Mydei snapped the belt across Phainon’s chest with a raised brow.

“Strip and let me have a taste first.”

Phainon looked at him for a moment with wide eyes and flushed cheeks, only to be prompted by the belt across his chest snapping against his skin again, making him yelp.

“Alright! Alright! You don't have to do that! I'm getting to it!” He complained with a scowl but complied to Mydei's demands swiftly, his stuffy clothes gone in just a moment, his only hiccup being his head getting caught in his obscenely tight black shirt.

“If you didn't want me to do that you wouldn't have paraded your chest around and emphasized it with that belt for everyone to see.” Mydei grumbled as he dragged Phainon down to sit in the low bench in the baths, before sitting on his lap. Phainon made an affronted noise, his hand coming up to grab Mydei’s chest again, squeezing his pec as if in admonishment. It didn't really work because all it did was make arousal flare in his gut again as he squirmed in Phainon’s lap, his nipples still reddened and sensitive.

“I don’t think you should be the one telling me about parading my chest around for everyone to see.” He said with a raised brow. Mydei simply rolled his eyes and shrugged Phainon’s hand off his chest. He leaned into him as he reached for the pomegranate scented oil in the toiletry basket beside them, purposefully pushing his chest against Phainon’s as he got hold of the vial of oil before leaning back, smiling when he saw Phainon was already very hard.

It wasn't a surprise considering his size and their proximity but Mydei got to see it bare again in all its gorgeous glory. He poured the oil on his hands and all over the cock, Phainon’s hiss sounding very distant as he saw the cock twitch and dribble precum. He swallowed down the saliva pooling in his mouth, feeling a little too hot as he put his hand around it in a daze, a wanton noise escaping him when he realized he couldn't wrap his hand around it.

He squeezed it once, feeling its velvety heat and its delicious firmness before he wrapped both hands around it to stroke, his eyes dazedly looking away from Phainon’s cock to his red face. He looked just as enticing as his cock; from his flushed cheeks and dewy skin to his brows furrowed in pleasure to the way his jaw was tight with tension, his teeth digging into his lower lip.

Mydei leaned in to kiss his cheek, his hands moving over Phainon's cock in a slow rhythm as he peppered kisses down his jaw, too besotted by how gorgeous Phainon looked. He panted into the crook of Phainon's neck as he squeezed his cockhead, pleasured just by holding the girth in his hands. Phainon whined, his hands a vice grip around his waist as his hips quivered as if he was trying very hard not to thrust into Mydei's hands.

He rubbed the sensitive underside and pressed against the dribbling slit, mesmerized by how *wide* he felt in his hands. He would press against everything inside Mydei, he'd mess up his insides and ruin him. Both of them moaned in unison when he began to quicken his strokes, the wet sounds obscene and loud in the space between them.

"Y-your hands," Phainon groaned, his calloused hands wrapping around his embarrassingly softer hands and squeezing.

"They're so soft and you smell so good and…*ungh,*" He moaned as he moved Mydei's hands along his thick cock, his breath quickening as needy noises escaped him. Mydei felt his cock stir, everything a little too hot…a little too good.

"I can't…y-your hands feel so good…Mine are so rough its frustrating, but-but yours…*ah*… so soft and you smell so sweet…wanna…wanna eat you up," He groaned right into Mydei's ear and he's gone hazy with arousal and he needs…he needs to—

He shrugged Phainon's hands off of his and released Phainon's cock, pushing the man urgently into the lip of the bath, the feral need making him impatient and hungry.

"Get up. Now. Sit up." Mydei growled, his hands impatiently grabbing Phainon and depositing him on the edge of the bath when he took too long to do it himself. He ignored his squawks of protest as he spread Phainon's legs and kneeled on the bench in the bath, diving in to taste his cock, his grip on Phainon's thighs trembling with need.

A whine escaped him unbidden when he finally pressed his lips to it, peppering kisses and kitten licks, making Phainon whine with impatience and thread his fingers through Mydei's hair, the firm pressure against his scalp delicious.

“I wasn’t…*gh*–aware you liked my cock so much,” Phainon said breathlessly, gasping when Mydei wrapped his lips around his flared head, his fingers tightening in Mydei’s hair.

Mydei scoffed around his cock, shoving more of it into his mouth greedily until his lips stretched wide around it. He teared up at first, choking when his cock hit the back of his throat, a wet gag escaping him as he powered through it, relaxing his throat and steadying his breathing, his bleary eyes looking up at Phainon, curious to see if his sloppy blowjob was able to pleasure him.

A whine escaped him when he saw the expression on Phainon’s face, the naked want and hunger in his dark eyes as he looked at Mydei on his knees with his cock stuffed down his throat making his own cock twitch and fill up. He squirmed, wanting to touch himself as he fucked his throat with Phainon’s cock but he needed them to wrap around the length of the cock he couldn’t fit into him yet. His eyelids fluttered when he managed to shove Phainon’s cock deeper into his throat, his eyes widening when Phainon thrusted into his mouth without warning, his eyes rolling back into his head when his thrusts turned erratic and rough, unprepared for the hot spurts of come spilling down his throat and the corners of his mouth. He tried swallowing as much as he could but he had to pull away from Phainon’s cock, panting and coughing as he tried to get his bearings.

He felt hands grab his face and rub the corners of his mouth, his eyes fluttering open to see Phainon’s distressed expression, not realizing he had closed them in the first place.

“Are…are you okay? I’m sorry I couldn’t help it, your throat was so tight and warm and it was squeezing me I couldn’t control it and—”

Mydei sighed, holding the hands cupping his cheeks.

“I—” he cleared his throat, sighing louder when Phainon just looked more distressed.

“I liked that. Quite a bit. But I reckon there’s another part of me that's warmer and tighter.”

He said with a smile as he crawled back up into Phainon’s lap and cupped his red cheeks and kissed the surprised gape of his mouth, rocking his cock into Phainon’s. The both of them

gasped from the touch, Phainon's a little louder considering he was still recovering from his orgasm.But shockingly enough he was already half way to being hard already, his endurance a little terrifying. He wonders if he's been possessed by a demon or if Phainon makes him act so hedonistic and hungry, his thoughts all replaced by only the want of Phainon fucking him till he could feel it for days.

"Do you always talk to your…bed mates like this?" Phainon asked, his voice rough as he gripped the skin of Mydei's waist. Mydei hummed, studying the way the Deliverer of Amphoreus stared at him like a coveted piece of meat. He smiled, licking his bottom lip, remembering Phainon's spend was still smeared all over his lips and cheeks. He tasted bitter and salty, nothing he would generally entertain but it was different knowing it was Phainon's. He swiped a finger through the mess and sucked his thumb, shrugging in response to Phainon's question.

"I've already told you everything about my life outside battle, Deliverer. Come to the conclusion yourself." He's very clearly a virgin, must he spell it out for Phainon?

Phainon's eyes widened, his surprise melting into upset. Mydei sat up straight in his lap, worried about the reaction. Did he come to the conclusion that Mydei was too much? Did he want to say it was a mistake? Was he…was he going to leave him?

"Phainon, I—"

"So you've only slept with someone after a battle, I see. You did tell me you were only used to touches on the battlefield. Does that mean…none of them treated you right? Were they so rough with you because you're immortal?"

Phainon asked, his jaw clenched and his voice dangerously quiet. Mydei blinked, wondering how he'd even come to that conclusion.

"Phainon, you—"

He was stopped again by gentle hands cupping his cheeks, compassionate blue eyes staring at him intently before he was carried like a hapless maiden again.

“Hks! What are you doing?!” He hissed, his confusion battling with the traitorous arousal he felt again from Phainon lugging him around like he weighed less than a bunch of grapes.

Mydei was placed gently on his clean sheets, dampening them with bath water and rendering the clean part null and void. He caged him between his strong arms, his eyes burning with determination and want.

“I will bring you pleasure and make you feel so good that you’ll only cry and scream from satisfaction,” He murmured, his fingers tracing the mark under his eye and tucking his hair behind his ear. Mydei’s next words were stopped by the stutter of his breath and the flushing of his cheeks, his eyes wide as Phainon gently wiped his face with a dampened cloth he had in a bowl on his bedside table. He climbed up onto the bed and in between Mydei’s legs, his hands now rubbing gentle circles into the skin of his inner thighs.

The misunderstanding was rather diabolical but something about Phainon made Mydei a little selfish and seeing him so protective and soft with him sent a frisson of want through him. He didn’t need anyone to protect him, he didn’t require to be treated like porcelain. But it was nice to be treated so sweetly, so nice that it turned him into a creature of want and greed. So Mydei simply did the most logical thing one does in a situation like this. He hooked his arms around Phainon’s neck and pulled him closer, his thighs spreading wider to accommodate the man in between them.

“Show me what you got then, Deliverer,” He said softly, leaning up to give him a chaste peck on the lips.

The one most important trait Phainon had was his absolute doggedness, his tenacity only matched by Mydei’s.

This clearly showed even in bed as a lover, his determination rather attractive.

He started slow, his lips soft as he kissed him deep, kissing the sore corner of his mouth before mouthing at his jaw, his sword calloused hands gentle on his skin as he dragged them down the ladder of his ribcage to the cradle of his waist. His open mouthed kisses were wet and warm against the sensitive skin of his neck, a soft noise of pleasure escaping him as he sighed into the touch, the slow simmering warmth dizzyingly good.

He whined when his hands and lips left him, his ears burning when he heard the pop of a vial, his vision hazy as he looked up to see Phainon pouring oil onto his hand and warming it up, his smile soft when he caught Mydei looking.

“Need this to not make it hurt,” He said apologetically, leaning back down to kiss his sternum as he spread Mydei’s thighs wider and pushed them up, Phainon’s lips now mouthing kisses down his ankles. The position he was in was so exposed, vulnerable. And yet he couldn’t help the way he was already so wet, precum dripping down his cock as he panted and spread his thighs wider, wanting Phainon to just bully himself inside him and feel his cock up to the throat but also loving the soft anticipation Phainon was building up for him, the gesture attractive and sweet.

“Just…just hurry,” He whispered, burning with mortification as he looked up at Phainon through his lashes and held his knees up to his chest, gasping when Phainon pulled him closer by the waist and smashed their lips together, groaning into his mouth as his his oil slick hand slid into the cradle of his thighs and wrapped around his cock. Mydei cried out into his mouth, thrashing in his arms as sword calloused fingers rubbed against his sensitive skin, his eyes roving down to see how Phainon’s hand swallowed the entirety of his cock, tears pricking his eyes when he jabbed his dribbling slit.

“Not there, please,” He whined, squirming and pushing his hand off his weeping cock and presented his twitching hole, hunger burning in his stomach as he caught the way Phainon’s eyes turned darker, his yellow pupils expanding as he took the entirety of Mydei in.

“It’s hard to say no when you look so delectable, spread out like a meal for me to sink my teeth in,” He said hoarsely, his fingers cupping Mydei’s balls before pressing into his taint. The faint tingle of pleasure made his eyelids flutter as he gasped, a whine spilling from his parted lips when Phainon finally slipped a finger inside.

It felt good, even better than his fingers, his hips insistently pushing Phainon’s finger deeper but was stopped by a firm hand on his waist.

“You seem…rather soft and loose.” Phainon murmured, slipping another finger inside with ease.

Something about the arousal and the fingers inside him made his lips looser than they usually were, a giddy smile pulling at his lips.

"Thats because I fucked myself with four of my fingers last night, wishing they were your cock," Mydei rasped, squirming as he raised his hips to meet the thrusts of Phainon's fingers.

"They weren't enough, they didn't *ah*–stretch me wide enough. W…wanted more…*mm*—wanted your cock," He panted, a scream ripping from his throat when the fingers inside found his sweet spot quicker than he ever did, his fingers clawing into Phainon's shoulders, the pleasure sweet and so, so good.

Phainon groaned in response to his words, resting his forehead against Mydei's as he panted.

"You…you're unreal," He groaned again, fitting two more fingers inside Mydei, the stretch so sugary sweet but just not enough. He needed more. He cried out when those fingers began to steadily piston into him, his lips open around obscene whines as he tried to keep his eyes open to watch the dogged determination in Phainon's eyes, the curl of platinum hair sticking to his sweaty temples, his teeth digging into his bruised bottom lip.

"D–*uh*– don't!…Stop…wanna…wanna come on your cock," He whined, clawing marks into Phainon's arms when he didn't stop. His thrusts were steady, uncaring of the scratches on his arms.

"You can come again, can't you? Let go, it's okay. I'll make you come on my cock again, okay?" Phainon said, his voice so sweet that Mydei's pleasured tears rolled down his cheeks as a sob escaped him, his nails digging deeper into Phainon's skin.

"You told me you'd be nice…" He hiccuped, moaning wantonly when he spilled all over himself, his thighs trembling as he sniffled, annoyance flaring up in him as he locked his legs around Phainon and flipped them over, glaring down at him with teeth bared. Phainon blinked up at him with wide eyes and was audacious enough to look surprised.

"Stay still Deliverer. Or I will cut your cock off." He growled. Phainon sat up, looking rather solemn, a hand on the small of his back and the other cupping his cheek.

“I…may have gotten a little carried away because you looked like you were enjoying it quite a bit,” He said softly, leaning in to give a soft peck on his lips, sweet and brief.

“But let me lead you just this once, yeah?” He said with a smile, his dimples cute and charming. Mydei sighed, aggrieved but unfortunately fond.

“Fine. Don’t try anything funny.” He muttered, looping his arms around Phainon’s neck and looking at him expectantly.

“Go on then, have your way with me.”

And that was all Phainon needed to finally lift him up and spear him on his cock. Mydei keened, his eyes widening from just the stretch of Phainon’s cockhead, his skin feeling too scalding hot as he gasped and clawed at Phainon, whining from the slow stretch that was so agonizingly delicious he felt his spent cock twitch, the oversensitivity sending a delectable twinge up his spine.

“Fa-*ahh*–aster,” Mydei gasped, squirming in Phainon’s solid hold around his waist, his feet kicking out from the overstimulation.

“Don’t *ghh*–want to hurt you.” Phainon groaned, his arms shaking from the exertion of going slow, Mydei crying out when Phainon’s flared head finally pushed itself inside. Mydei squirmed, rocking his hips and trying to stuff more of Phainon into him, making the man’s hold on his waist slip. The loss of grip made Phainon’s cock shove itself all the way inside, bullying its way into Mydei’s quivering channel, the curve of it deliciously pressing into his prostate, the sheer barrage of pleasure making him scream as he came dry, a pathetic spurt of clear liquid being the only thing his cock could manage, hot tears rolling down his cheeks from the overstimulation.

And like a thread that had snapped He clawed Phainon’s shoulders for leverage as he rocked into Phainon’s cock, almost crazed in his endeavour as he rode his dick, fueled by Phainon’s whines and moans and his bruising grip on his waist, hoping it left a mark that even his immortality would take a while to heal.

“My…Mydei,” Phainon gasped, holding him so close as he thrust his dick in tandem to the rolls of his hip, pushing into him and pressing him in all the right places, fucking so deep into him that if he had a womb he would have already pierced it.

“You’re so infuriatingly sweet, it drives me up the *ah*—wall!” Mydei growled between keens and moans, his head blissfully fuzzy but his heart sweetly aching with so many things to say.

“To treat someone like me so gently, to hold me close and make me feel things I’ve never felt before,” He gasped, tears blurring his vision as he curled into Phainon, wanting to keep him inside him forever, to rip his torso open and keep him safe inside till the Flame Chase was done so they could live in a small cottage and maybe adopt a child or two, to raise them together and grow old together, to die in each other’s arms. A sob escaped him as he held him close, slowing down to let Phainon thrust erratically into him, shuddering when he felt him cum into him, warm and wet and all his. He buried his face into Phainon’s neck holding him close, the devastating realization that he liked Phainon more than he thought he did leaving him winded like he’d been hit by a particularly large titankin.

“...Mydei?” Phainon asked, gentle and soft and so, so sweet. He wanted him. He wanted him so much it ached.

“Just…stay. Only for a while,” He whispered, holding him tighter, knowing he was being selfish but wanting just for a little more.

Couldn’t he have just a little bit more?

“I’ll be here,” Phainon murmured, holding him close.

He didn’t realize he had passed out, waking up next in Phainon’s arms. His heart threatened to leave his ribcage and squirrel its way into Phainon’s chest, his throat tight with too much emotion. He was still tender from the realization of his feelings and looking at Phainon’s soft face, unguarded in his sleep, only made his eyes burn with tears. He rested his head against Phainon’s chest, falling asleep to the steady beat of his heart, deciding to be voraciously greedy just this once.

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End Notes

After 80 crashouts and 8,000 words worth of sirendei scrapped and another 20 crashouts later I decided to cook this...i hope you guys liked it!! ;_; I feel like i got a little rusty so i apologize if it feels clunky...

Also just realized after reread that Mydei never cleared up the misunderstanding in the end...lol

Anyways thank you for reading!
Let's talk phaidei on twitter!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!